

Mail. Rather than bore you to tears with an interface based around folders, remember, Windows Phone works the way you think rather than force you to understand how it works. Mail instead presents commonly needed email views such as all email, unread email, flagged email, urgent email. Mail starts up in the All (for “all e-mail”) view. But you can easily swipe the screen horizontally to pivot, or navigate, through the other views. The Unread view, for example, displays only those e-mails that are currently unread. The Flagged view displays those messages that are said to be flagged, a Microsoft invention that is used heavily throughout the software giant’s many e-mail applications, servers, and services. In the Microsoft world, a flagged message is one that requires follow-up. So you can “set” a flag on an e-mail, and “clear” a flag, which is like removing the flag. But good worker drones will “complete” a flagged message, meaning that they followed up as required.

In the Urgent view, you see those messages that have been specified by the sender as having an urgent priority rating. By default, emails are sent with a normal priority rating, and while it’s even possible to specify low priority in some email solutions, including Mail on Windows Phone, that’s rarely used. How is this different from a flagged message, you ask? Primarily in two ways. First, it’s a de facto industry standard in the sense that virtually every email solution supports creating and understanding urgent mails. And second, as noted previously, this rating is applied by the sender, not by the receiver, as is the case with flagged emails.

Triaging email

Receiving hundreds of email messages every day has become a common phenomenon, and one can’t and doesn’t want to read every single one of them. The reasons for this are pragmatic, and should apply to your own email as well. Much of the mail is unwanted, such as mailing lists that inadvertently



Selection boxes in mail